

Ohio River Trail Council Cycling Club

Wheeling Heritage Trail Tour

10, 30, or 62 Mile Bike Trail Ride

City/State: Wheeling, West Virginia

County: Ohio, Marshall, Brooke

Date: Sunday, May 27, 2012

Time: Registration at 8:00 am; Mass start at am (62 mile riders depart at 8:30 am)

Surface: Paved, streets

RSVP: ortctrailride@gmail.com



Come out for a ride! This is part of a trail ride series sponsored by the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) intended to celebrate wellness and bring awareness to the wonderful trails in our 4-state region (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia) as well as encourage new trail development.

With the backing of the Department of the Interior's National Park Service Rivers, Trails and Conservation Assistance Program the [Ohio River Trail Council](#) (ORTC) and the [Ohio Valley Trail Partners](#) (OVTP) along with other like-minded trail groups are supporting the "Tri-state Initiative" which proposes the broad vision of a trail system which interconnects Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia.

Two of the proposed greenways include the Cleveland to Pittsburgh Trail and the Pittsburgh to Wheeling Trail. The development of this tri-state recreation and parks system will foster further recreation and cultural-based economic development by capitalizing on the popularity of nature tourism.

All riders are welcome for this rails-to-trails, moderate-paced ride!

For this ride...

The ORTC Cycling Club visits the Wheeling Heritage Trail. Join us, as we link up with the Mountain State Rail Trailers, for the [6th Annual Wheeling Heritage Trail Bicycle Tour](#).

Pre-registration by May 25th is \$25 per person. Registration the day of the tour is \$30. The family fee is \$10 for each additional family member to a maximum of \$50 Children under 12 are free with a registered adult and there must be a registered adult per child.

This is a non-race benefit event for cyclists and trail enthusiasts. Registration covers a pre-tour bicycle safety check, ride assistance, snacks and water at rest stops, and lunch. T-shirts are guaranteed to the first 250 pre-registered cyclists.

Cyclists will choose one of three distances. Cyclists riding 10 and 30 miles will remain on the trail. The 100 km (62 mile) ride will follow Heritage Trail to Short Creek Road and leave the trail for a hilly loop through Bethany and West Liberty with a stop at Bethany College.

Participants will return to Heritage Port for lunch and entertainment. The tour will take place rain or shine!

Please join the [Ohio River Trail Council](#) (ORTC) as we support our friends and neighbors the [Ohio Valley Trail Partners](#) (OVTP) in their sixth year of celebrating the Wheeling Heritage Trail!

Give the OVTP a call at (740) 635-3700 if you have questions or [EMAIL OVTP](#).

Click [HERE](#) to print a registration flier or [HERE](#) for a map of the distance route.

[Wheeling Heritage Trail Map](#)

Features of Interest:

The great 1849 suspension bridge of Wheeling extended the National Road west, bringing people and goods to the city. At the northernmost navigable port on the Ohio River, overland routes, river traffic and railroads converged, attracting entrepreneurs and manufacturers of iron, steel, textiles, glass, tobacco and other goods.

The railroads provided access to markets for Wheeling products. At one time as many as seven railroads served the city, including the Baltimore & Ohio, the Wheeling & Lake Erie, the Pittsburgh Wheeling & Kentucky, the Hempfield, the Panhandle, the Ohio River & Western and the Pennsylvania Railroad. Today, no railroads roll through Wheeling, and the long-familiar train whistle of yesterday is silent.

In their place, the city of Wheeling has converted more than 13 miles of former railroad beds into an extraordinary trail experience. West Virginia's Ohio River Trail runs north-south starting at the city line in South Wheeling and reaches the Pike Island Dam where the trail continues into Brooke County. In Wheeling's 8.5-mile distance, the trail follows the river, passing many of the city's industrial sites and crossing through Wheeling Heritage Port. Along the way, stop to read the historic signs, take in the National Historic Landmark Wheeling Suspension Bridge, and view the river traffic particularly as barges pass through the locks at Pike Island.

The Wheeling Creek Trail runs east-west providing opportunities to cross the Hempfield Viaduct high above the creek and experience the Hempfield Tunnel. The trail begins in downtown connecting to the Ohio River Trail at Heritage Port and extends five miles to Elm Grove.

The Wheeling Heritage Trails are an important element adding to Wheeling's vitality. The Wheeling National Heritage Area preserves and celebrates the city's dramatic setting, resources and history, including its role as the birthplace of the state of West Virginia during the Civil War. A National Heritage Area is a part of our country's landscape that has been recognized by the United States Congress for its unique contribution to the American experience.

Don't forget your camera!

Website Links and references:

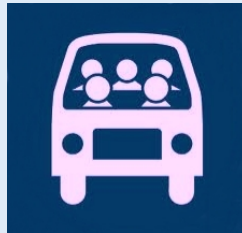
[Ohio Valley Trail Partners](#)

<http://www.wheelingheritagetrail.com/>

<http://www.trailink.com/trail/greater-wheeling-trail.aspx>

Carpooling:

We are glad to facilitate carpooling as well. Just RSVP or contact Nathan Peluso at ortctrailride@gmail.com. Carpooling meeting locations are either Beaver, Cranberry Twp., Moon Twp., or Pittsburgh, Pa.



Weather & Cancellations:

The weather forecast is mostly sunny and 83 degrees. Please visit the [ORTC website](#) for cancellations before you depart for the trail. In addition, persons who RSVP will be sent an email regarding schedule changes. Rides that are cancelled due to inclement weather are usually rescheduled for the next day for Saturday rides or the following week for Sunday rides.

Trailhead Address and Directions:

Wheeling Heritage Port
1201 Water St., Wheeling, WV, 26003

Heritage Port is located at 12th and Water Streets in Wheeling, West Virginia.

[Wheeling Heritage Port Trailhead Map](#)



[Wheeling Heritage Port, WV Photo 1](#)

Wheeling Heritage Port Trailhead Photo 1

GPS: 40.067481,-80.724578

Drive Time

Drive time from Pittsburgh: 1 hour 15 minutes

Drive time from Monaca: 1 hour 30 minutes

Lunch:

We will meet for lunch after the ride.

Ohio River Trail Council

The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) is a Pennsylvania based non-profit, volunteer-led corporation whose mission is to establish, promote, protect and preserve a multi-use trail, the Ohio River Trail (ORT), along the "La Belle Riviere" or the Ohio River and its tributaries. The ORTC is currently planning & developing a 41-mile bike and water trail, the Ohio River Trail (ORT), along the Ohio River, from Coraopolis, Pa (near Pittsburgh) to Ohioville, Pa. (near East Liverpool, OH). The ORT is part of the *Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area*, *Lewis & Clark Trail* and is a candidate for part of the *U.S. Bicycle Route 50, Pittsburgh to Cleveland Trail*, and a portion of the *Underground Railroad Bicycle Route, Pittsburgh spur*. The proposed ORT will also follow parts of the "Great Path" and the *Lincoln Highway*. The ORT will serve as a key segment in the interconnection of existing land trails in the quad-state area (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia). Specifically, the proposed Ohio River Trail will connect the *Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway* in Columbiana County, Ohio to the *Great Allegheny Passage* in Allegheny, County Pennsylvania forming a mega-trail from the great lakes region to our nation's capitol.



Donations

The ORTC is an organization committed to excellence, with a clear vision and a passion for delivering outstanding results. We ask you to form an alliance with us to capitalize on our strengths in order to guarantee a bright future for our rivers, forests, and towns. Please visit www.ohiorivertrail.org for additional information and a [donation form](#).



Ohio River Trail Cycling Club

The Ohio River Trail Cycling Club is a recreational club that promotes health, wellness and fitness in our community through a variety of biking events. Our goal is to encourage cyclists of all abilities to explore the wonderful opportunities of the region - from the Heritage Trail of Pittsburgh to the rural scenery of the 4-state area, including Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia. The club provides cyclists with a diversity of riding experiences. Ohio River Trail Council members can be seen on city bikes, comfort bikes, cyclocross bikes, hybrids, mountain bikes, recumbents, road bikes, touring bikes and tandems.

The ORTC Cycling Club supports and promotes safe bicycle riding. If you have been inactive for several years or are currently under medical care, please consult your doctor before starting a new exercise program. It is highly recommended to always carry water and food. In addition, please bring a spare tube, pump and tools to replace a flat tire. A Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) approved bicycle helmet securely fitted and fastened is required on all ORTC Trail Series Rides. In order to participate in our events please print and sign the [OHIO RIVER TRAIL COUNCIL CYCLING CLUB RELEASE](#) and mail to ORTC 1100 Pennsylvania Av Monaca, Pa 15061. The ORTC club members serve as ambassadors for bicycling every time we ride thus projecting a positive image of bicycling to the public. Always follow the rules of the road!

About the Trail Ride Series:

- Trails rides are 10-50 miles in length.
- Moderate and self-paced rides located within a 2 hour drive of Pittsburgh, Pa.
- Meet for lunch or dinner either mid-way or at the end.
- Two - four rides per month on Saturday or Sunday.
- Feel free to forward this email. This publication is intended for widespread distribution.

Example rides include the [Allegheny Highlands Trail](#), [Allegheny River & Samuel Justus Trails](#), [Armstrong Trail](#), [Arrowhead Trail](#), [Bike and Hike Trail](#), [Butler-Freeport Trail](#), [C & O Canal Towpath Trail](#), [Conotton Creek Trail](#), [Deckers Creek Trail](#), [Ghost Town Trail](#), [Greater Wheeling Trail](#), [Hoodlebug Trail](#), [Little Beaver Creek Greenway](#), [Lower Trail](#), [Mahoning Shadow Trail](#), [Maurice K. Goddard State Park Trail](#), [Mill Creek MetroParks Bikeway](#), [Montour Trail](#), [Ohio & Erie Canal Towpath Trail](#), [Oil Creek State Park Trail](#), [Panhandle Trail](#), [Pine Creek Trail](#), [Sandy Creek Trail](#), [Stavich Trail](#), [Steel Valley Trail](#), [Three Rivers Heritage Trail](#), [Western Reserve Greenway Trumbull MetroParks](#), [West Penn Trail](#), and [Youghiogheny River Trail](#).

Ride Schedule

Please refer to the provisional ORTC Trail Series [Ride Schedule](#) or ORTC [Event Calendar](#) for additional dates and times. Click here to view the [ORTC meeting schedule](#).

Membership

To join the Ohio River Trail Council and become a member of the ORTC Cycling Club please download a [membership application](#) and mail your contribution to the ORTC office. Feel free to forward this message to a friend.



Correspondence

Please visit our [website](#) and [register](#) to receive ORTC correspondence. Thank you for your support.



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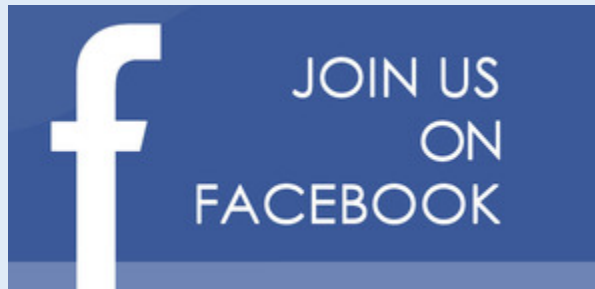
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For questions and comments please contact:

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